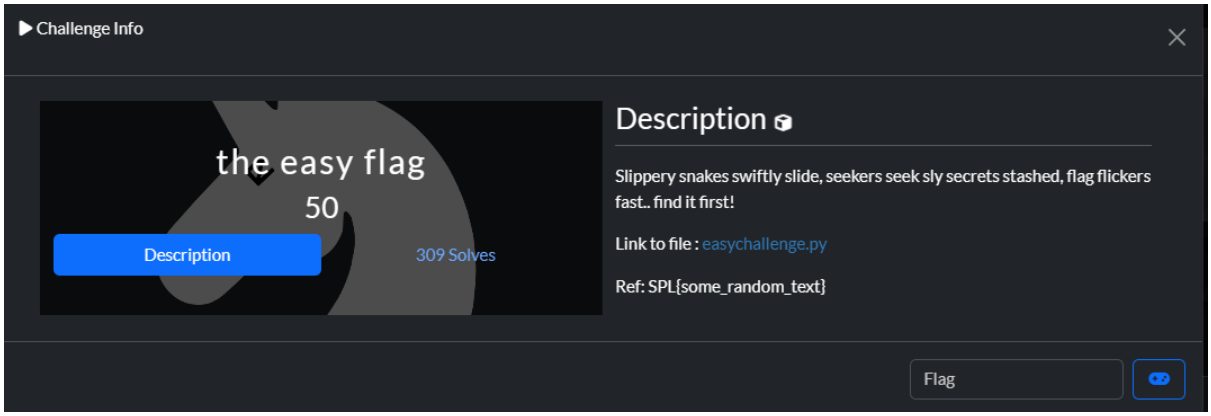
Challenge Name: the easy flag - 50 (MISC)



TL;DR

The provided Python file was heavily obfuscated but contained a compressed/encoded payload. I extracted and ran a small extractor (`solution.py`) which decompressed the hidden script and printed the flag.

Flag: `SPL{spl_is_cr4zy}`

Steps (reproducible)

1. **Unzip the challenge**

```
unzip easychallenge.zip
```

```
┌──(kali㉿kali)-[~/1nf1n1ty/easychall]
└─$ unzip easychallenge.zip
Archive:  easychallenge.zip
  inflating: easychallenge.py
```

2. **Verify files**

```
ls
```

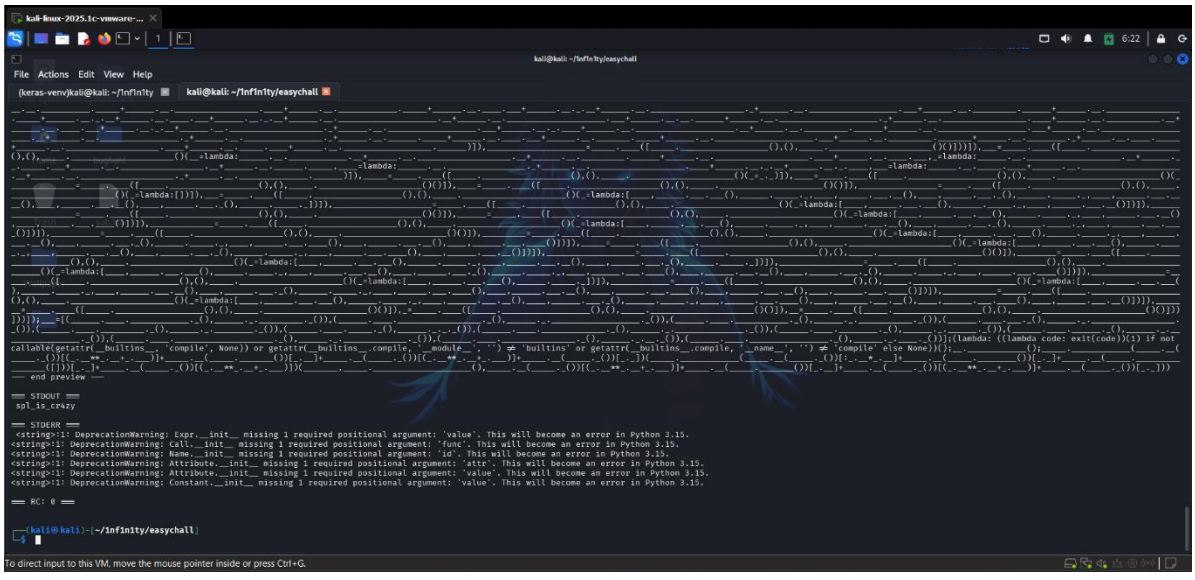
```
┌──(kali㉿kali)-[~/1nf1n1ty/easychall]
└─$ ls
easychallenge.py  easychallenge.zip
```

3. **Create the extractor (solution.py)**

Save this exact extractor as `solution.py` in the same folder:

```
┌──(kali㉿kali)-[~/1nf1n1ty/easychall]
└─$ nano solution.py

┌──(kali㉿kali)-[~/1nf1n1ty/easychall]
└─$ cat solution.py
#!/usr/bin/env python3
# short_extract.py — compact extractor

import re, sys, zlib, subprocess
from pathlib import Path

IN = Path(sys.argv[1]) if len(sys.argv) > 1 else Path("easychallenge.py")
OUT = Path("/tmp/easy_decoded.py")
if not IN.exists():
    sys.exit(f"ERROR: input {IN} not found")

txt = IN.read_text(errors="ignore")
cand = sorted([h for h in re.findall(r"[0-9a-fA-F]{8,}", txt) if h.startswith(("78", "789c"))],
              key=len, reverse=True)
if not cand:
    sys.exit("ERROR: no suitable hex blob found")
hexstr = cand[0]
blob = bytes.fromhex(hexstr)
try:
    src = zlib.decompress(blob)
except Exception as e:
    sys.exit(f"ERROR decompressing: {e}")

OUT.write_bytes(src)
print(f"WROTE: {OUT} ({len(src)} bytes)\n—— preview ——")
print("\n".join(src.decode("utf-8", "replace").splitlines()[:12]))
print("—— end preview ——\n")

# try run (time-limited) and show output
try:
    p = subprocess.run([sys.executable, "-I", str(OUT)], capture_output=True, text=True, timeout=6)
    print("=== STDOUT ===\n", p.stdout)
    print("=== STDERR ===\n", p.stderr)
    print("=== RC:", p.returncode, "===\n")
except subprocess.TimeoutExpired as t:
    print(f"ERROR: execution timed out; partial stdout:\n{t.stdout}\npartial stderr:\n{t.stderr}")

┌──(kali㉿kali)-[~/1nf1n1ty/easychall]
└─$
```

Example output from running the extractor (truncated for clarity):



Why it worked (short)

- `easychallenge.py` hid a large hex blob that, when decoded, yielded a zlib-compressed Python script.
- The extractor decompressed that blob and executed/printed the hidden content.
- Running the extracted code produced the flag string.

Final

Compact and classic — an obfuscated script with an embedded zlib blob. Extract, run, done.

Flag: `SPL{spl_is_cr4zy}`

`~By: 1nf1n1ty`